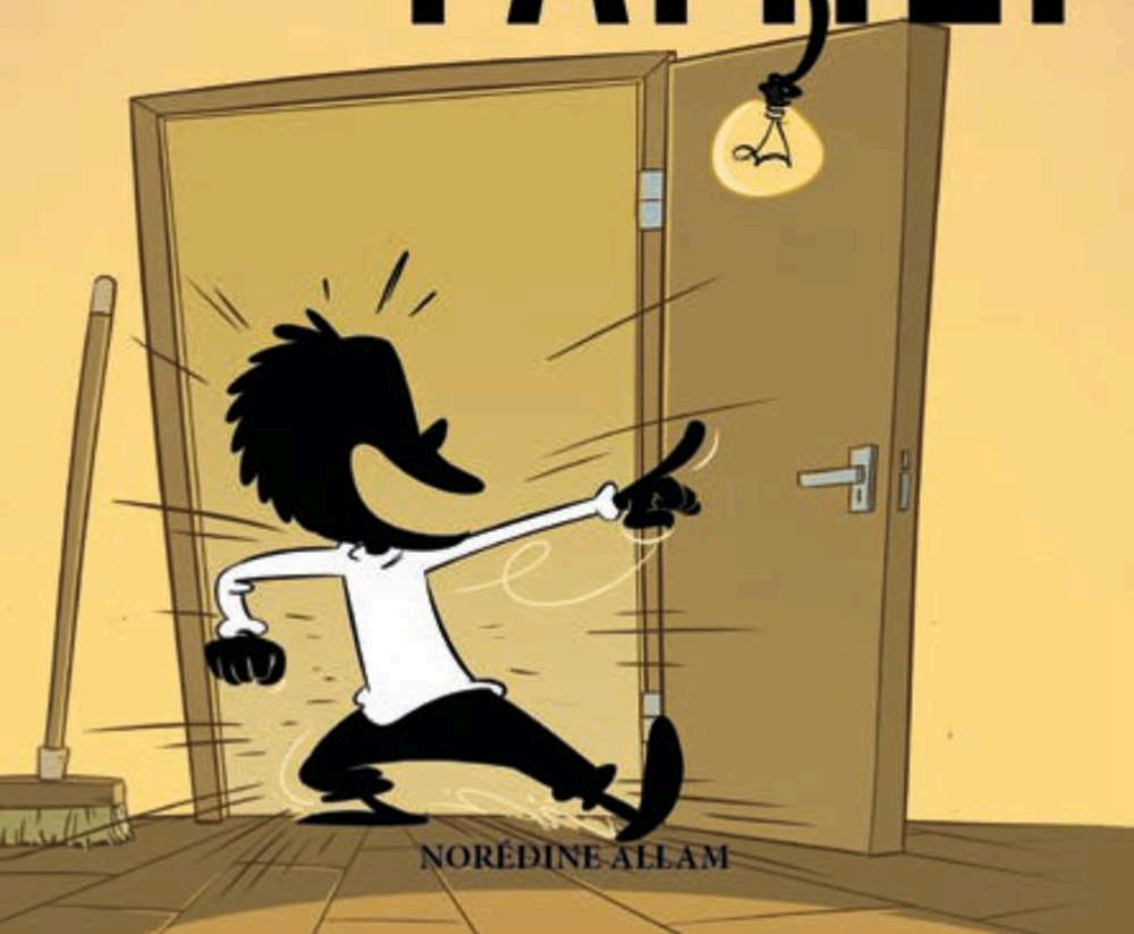
VOL 6: WALAD'S 30 CHALLENGES

THE FOULANE FAMILY



NORÉDINE ALLAM

THE FOULANE FAMILY

Vol 6. Walad's 30 challenges

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The Foulane Family
Vol.6
Walad's 30 challenges
By Norédine Allam.

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1. The list

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Today during break time, Jeremy came up with a fun idea for the group. We all had to complete 30 challenges at home in just one month! As you might have calculated, that's one per day.

Each of the members of our group – that's Rachid, Anass, Jeremy and me – had to write our own list on a sheet of paper. Then, at the end of the 30 days, announce to the group – without cheating – whether they'd completed all 30 challenges or not.

I thought about it and started writing.



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Barely two minutes later, Anass was the first to read his paper:

"I'm taking on the challenge of doing 30 physical activities every day this month!"

"But you're already doing that?" Jeremy protested.

"Yes, but I'm talking about 30 activities in 'warrior mode!'"

"What does 'warrior mode' mean?" Rachid asked.

"That means it's no laughing matter..." Jeremy replied.

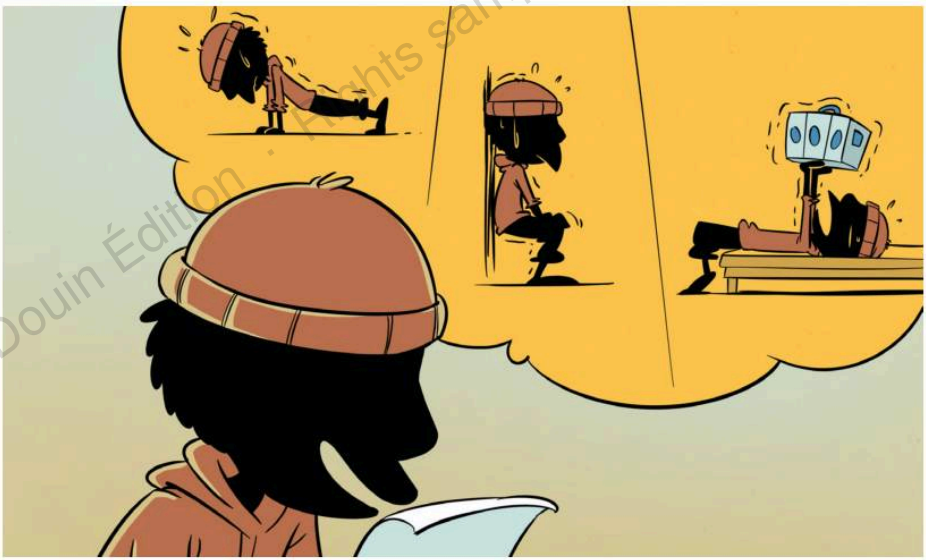
"Exactly! No more laughing:

Day 1: 50 push-ups in a row.

Day 2: 10 minutes in a chair position against the wall.

Day 3: 10 lifts of a pack of milk cartons while lying down

Day 4..."



"Okay, okay. We get it!" Jeremy cut in. "It's my turn. For the next 30 days, I'm announcing my challenge: find 30 lost items!"

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“Huh..? If they’re lost, then you’re not going to find them!” I protested. “Or if you do find them, then they weren’t really lost – just badly stored!”

“He’s not wrong,” Rachid supported.

“You don’t get it..! That’s what this challenge is all about!” Jeremy retorted. “It must seem impossible to do, but it must also be possible.”

“Okay. And what objects are you looking to find?” asked Anass.

“So here’s my list: find the battery-powered solar watch that Taha lent me, the peanut-shaped cufflink that Grandma gave me for my 6th birthday, the nine-colour pen that Dad bought me for the start of the school year, the gold engagement ring that Mum gave me...”



“WAIT, WHAT?” Anass exclaimed. “Did you lose your Mum’s gold ring??”

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“It wasn’t my fault! I brought it to school to show to the teacher, but when Paco saw it he asked if he could borrow it so he could show it to his mother.” Jeremy explained. “Initially, I said no, but then he offered to give me a ninja marble in exchange. So I said yes... But I never saw the ring again...”



“It’s true that Paco’s marbles are really beautiful,” Rachid said.

“And you, Rachid. What are your challenges?” Anass asked.

“Let me guess!” I said. “I bet it’s about food? Ha ha ha!”

“You’re correct! He he!” Anass replied. “But this time, I’ve set the bar high. I’m making it a point to eat something I don’t like every day.”

“Ouch! You sure?” I said, having compassion for him.

“Yes! My Mum always tells me that if I want to grow, I have to eat everything. So, I’m getting into it...”

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“And what are all of the ‘things’ you need to eat every day?” asked Jeremy.

“Day 1, a whole lettuce without mayonnaise. Day 2, a cayenne pepper... or half. Day 3, Brussels sprouts...”



“YUCK! Brussels sprouts?!” Jeremy exclaimed. “But you never will! Last time, you almost fainted in the school canteen when you saw a pea in your mashed potatoes!”

“Okay, my poor man. I wish you all the best with your challenges.” I added.

“What about you, Walad? What did you write on your paper?” Anass asked.

“For my list, I was inspired by a book by BDouin that I have at home. It’s called – The 30 Good Deeds of the Muslim!”

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"I'm taking each of these good deeds and setting myself the goal of doing them every day."

Anass took my list and showed it to the group.

When they read it, they made wide eyes. They were convinced that I would never make it!



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I had a month ahead of me to prove them wrong... insha'Allah.



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2. DAY 01: The search for science

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To make sure I finished all my challenges on time, I wrote them down in my diary. Every day has its own challenge. The first was to 'pursue science'.

Sheesh... for this first one, I didn't even understand the title!

Science? But what kind of science? Natural or physical? Or even chemical? And where to find it?? In which country??

So I went to see Oummi and asked her to tell me a little more about it.



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"Science, in this case Walad, is what allows you to better understand your religion and what Allah created you for."

"And where can I find this science?" I asked.

"Among the Scholars!" replied Oummi.

"Ha... but there are no Scholars here..."

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"No, but luckily for you, Scholars write books! And there are plenty of books in the library in the living room."

"Great! That means I'll be able to complete my first challenge." I replied. "Oummi, can you give me a mission to do today that proves I have pursued science?"

"Hmm... okay. I challenge you to find the evidence that allows me to combine my prayers when travelling!"

"Okay... that must be in the book 'How to Pray?'"

"Maybe..." Oummi replied with a smile.

Okay! All I had to do now was find this book.
I engaged SPORT+ mode and sped off towards the living room in a search for science! Vrooomm!



When I saw the library, I was reminded of how much Abi and Oummi loved books.

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There were more than five hundred of them, all neatly arranged – or rather, squeezed tightly together.



I rolled up my sleeves and started reading the edges of each book... even if rolling up my sleeves didn't really help me see any better...

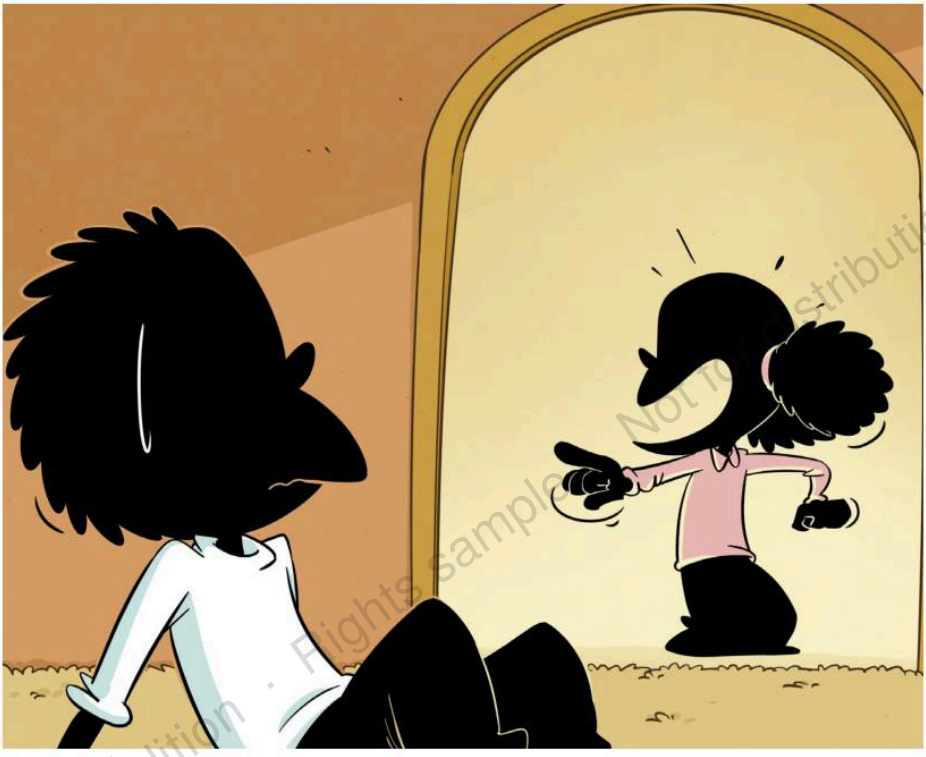
After an hour, and after carefully reading the spine of each book from the bottom of the bookcase, I still hadn't found this famous book. And from a slight general glance at the library, I hadn't even done half of it yet!



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That's when Binti arrived.

"Walad in front of the library! Now, I've seen everything! Mwhaha!" She exclaimed, giggling.



"Laugh all you want. I don't know what to do..."

"What's the matter?" asked Binti.

"For the first of my 30 challenges, I have to find the book on prayer. But I've been searching for over an hour..."

"Are you talking about the little green book that explains how to pray?"

"Yes, that's the one!"

"The one with a picture of a prayer mat on the cover?"

"Yes!! Do you know where it is?! That would be great!"

"Maybe..." she said with her little smirk.

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